Lab Module 1 Create Database Instance on Cloud

Learning Objectives:

1. Set-up an IBM Cloud account.
2. Familiarize with IBM DB2 Lite Plan Account.
3. View and save DB2 credentials.

Setup your IBM Cloud Account and Database Instance

IBM DB2 on Cloud has provisioned simple access to your database using a web browser. No need to download or install anything.

IBM Cloud provides Data and Analytics services such as IBM DB2. You can create a Lite account on IBM Cloud at no charge.

Setup your IBM Cloud Lite Account

IBM Cloud is a computing platform that combines platform-as-a-service (PaaS) within infrastructure-as-a-service (IaaS). You can build business applications quickly and manage your applications to the cloud. Please follow the steps below:

1. Sign up at IBM Cloud:
   https://cloud.ibm.com/registration?target=https%3A//cloud.ibm.com/docs

   Note: If you have an existing IBM Cloud Account, simply log in. If you are notified to continue by providing credit card information, create/use another email and use the above link to credit your free account.

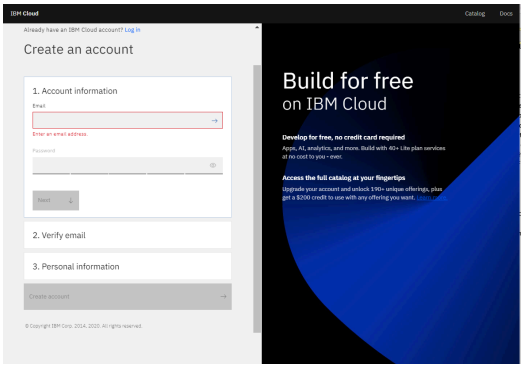


Figure 1.1 Create Account.

2. As part of the sign-up process you will need to click on the link in your email to verify and activate the account.

3. Acknowledge the Account Privacy Agreement by clicking **Proceed**:

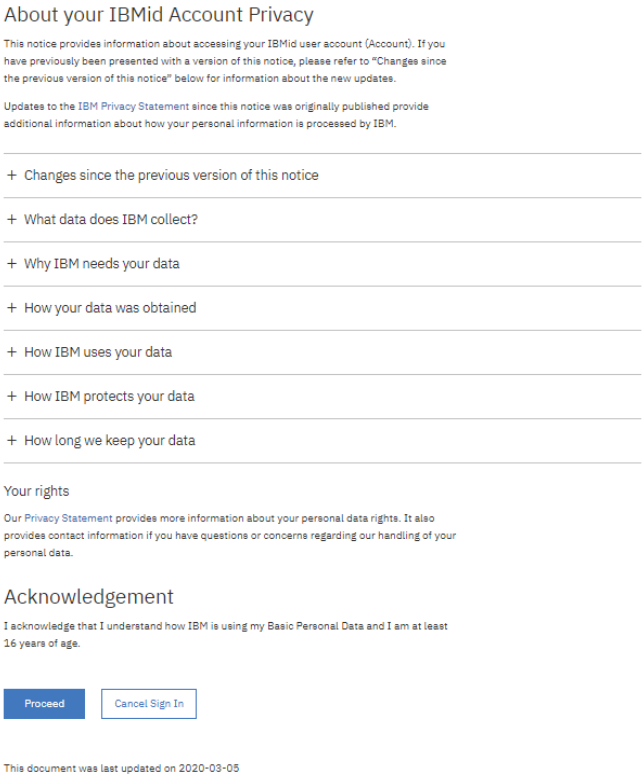


Figure 1.2 Account Privacy Agreement.

Create DB2 Resource

As you reach the dashboard of your cloud account, you need to create your DB2 Resource by selecting the **Create Resource** button.

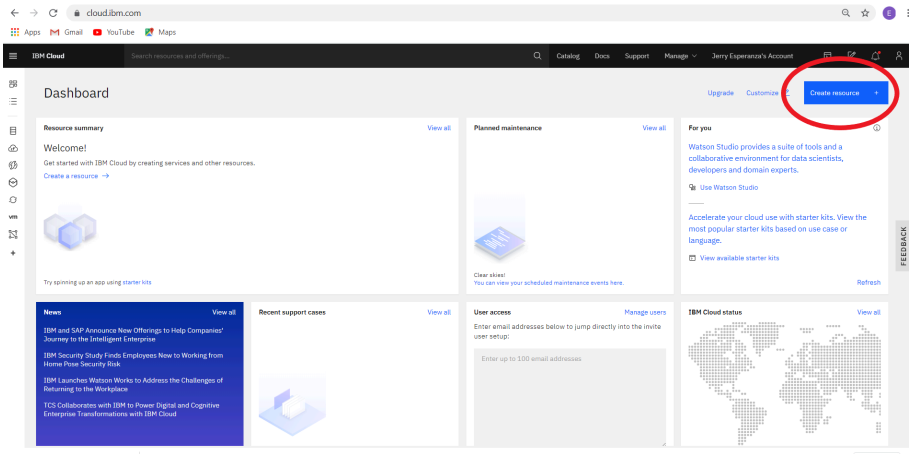


Figure 1.3 Create Resource.

You will be provided with IBM Resources but you will select DB2 as your selected resource in Figure 1.4.

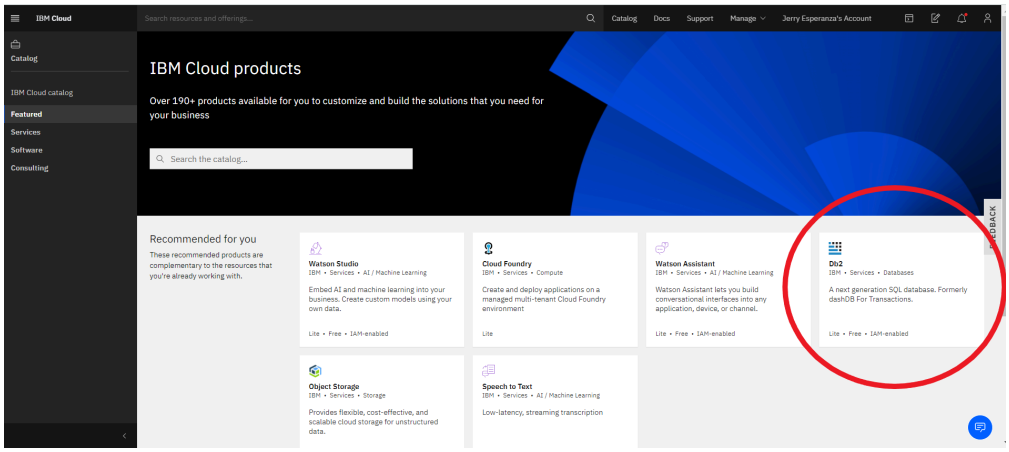


Figure 1.4 DB2 Resource

To avail of the DB2 free resource (Lite Account), you need to click the **Create** button as shown in Figure 1.5. NOTE: DB2 Lite Account is already pre-selected for you.

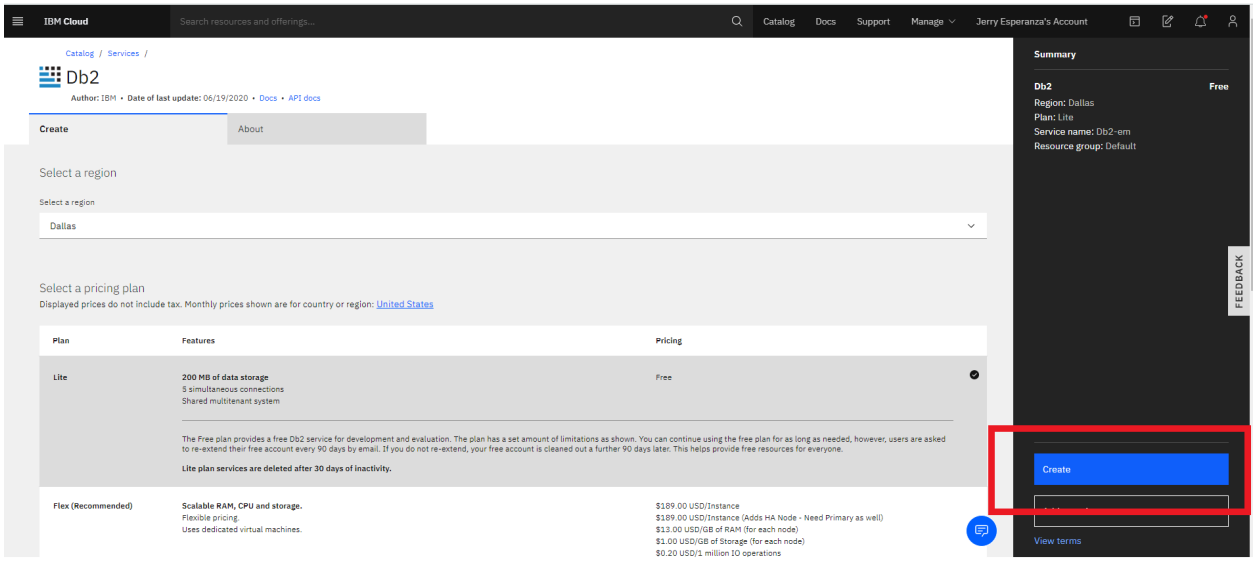


Figure 1.5 Create Lite Account.

Figure 1.6 confirms that you have created your own DB2 Cloud Account. Every user account in IBM cloud has a different DB2 account instance name.

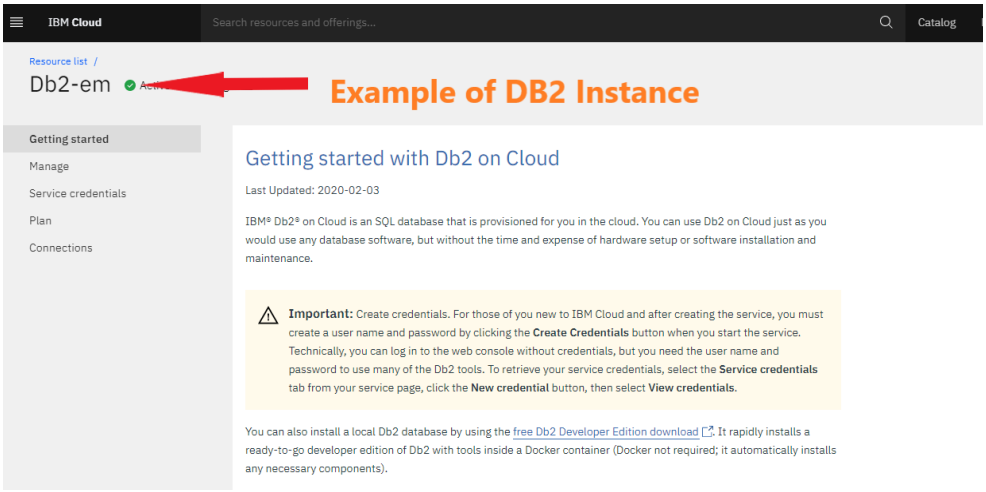


Figure 1.6 Created DB2 Instance name.

Activate Credentials

Every time you need to set connections from your database to other applications, you must provide credentials (database name, user name, password). Provide credentials to your database by clicking the **Service Credentials** button.

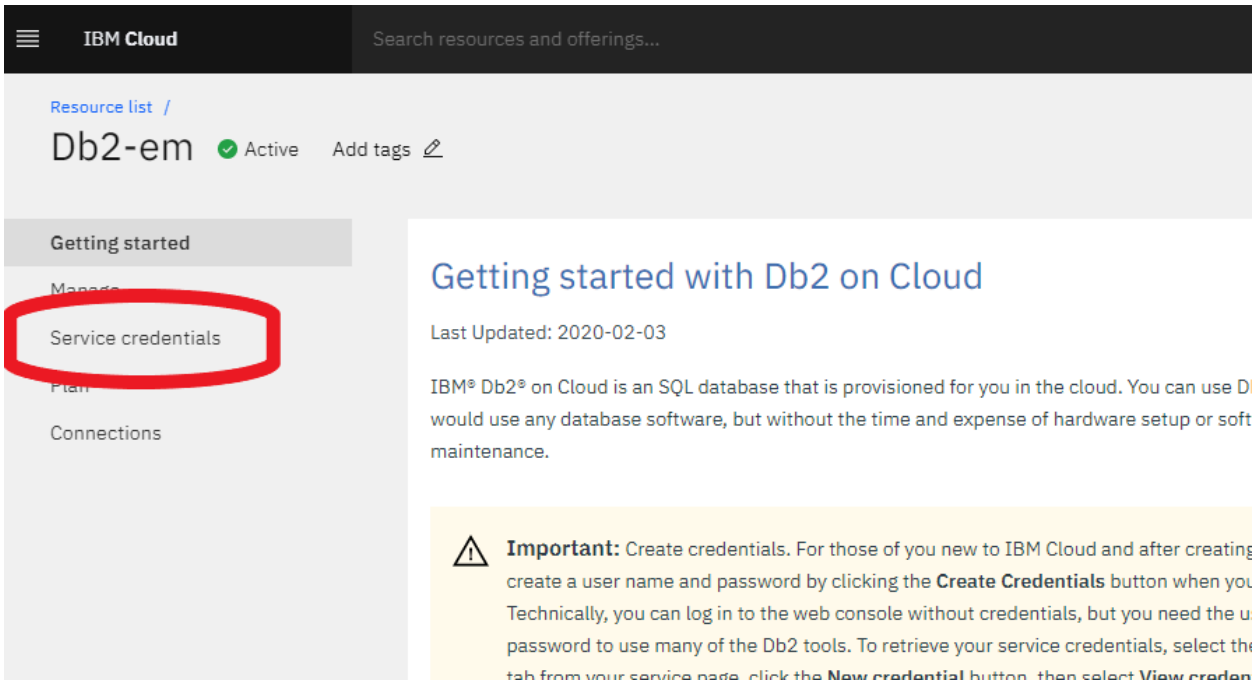


Figure 1.7 Setting up credentials

Select **New credentials**.

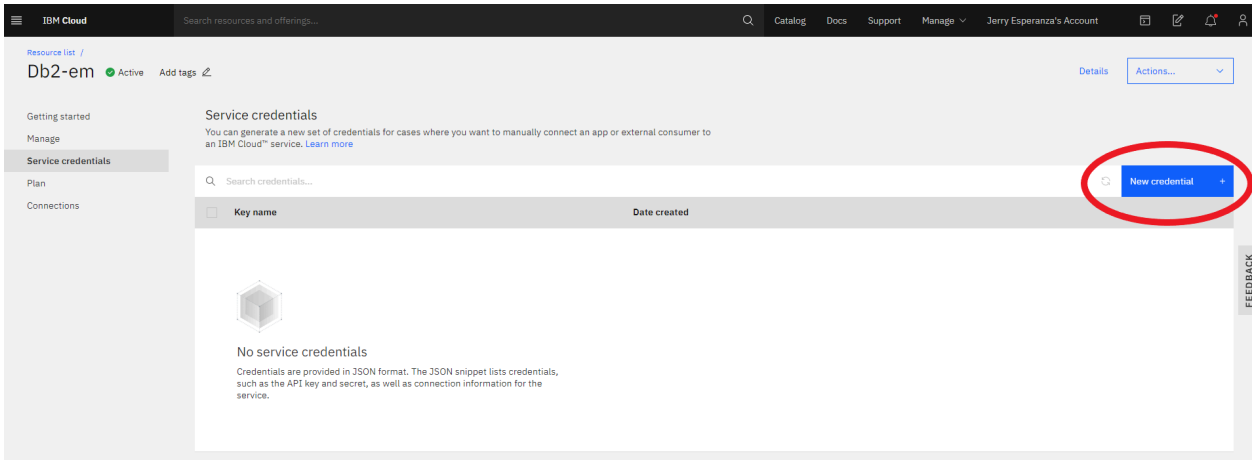


Figure 1.8 Adding new credential

Confirm the creation of new credentials. You may supply your own credentials name or select the default name supplied.

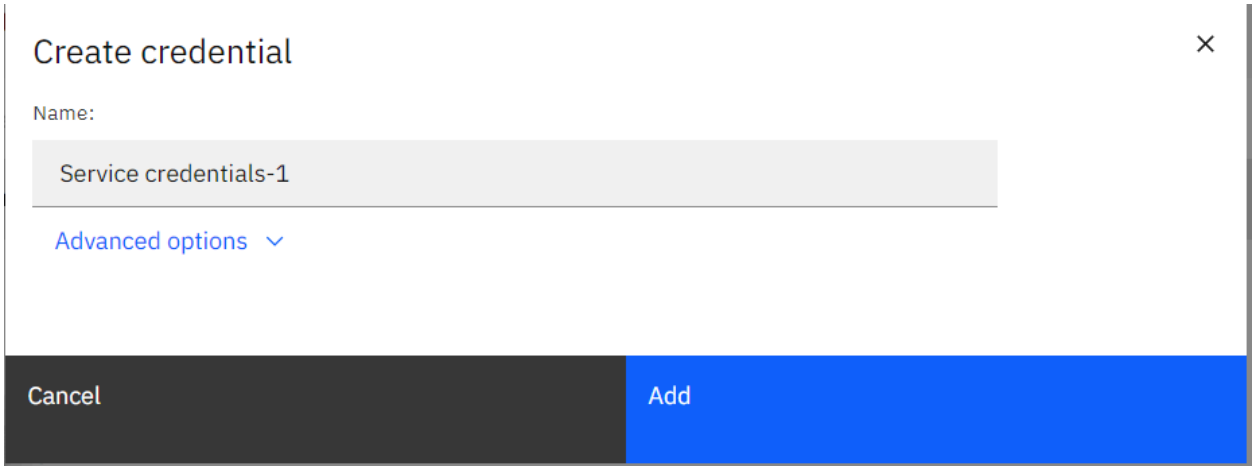


Figure 1.9 Adding new credentials.

Collapse the arrow to view your newly created credentials. Try to secure this information to avoid others accessing your database.



Figure 1.10 Credentials information.

Access the DB2 Interface

Press **Open Console** to go to the interface of DB2.

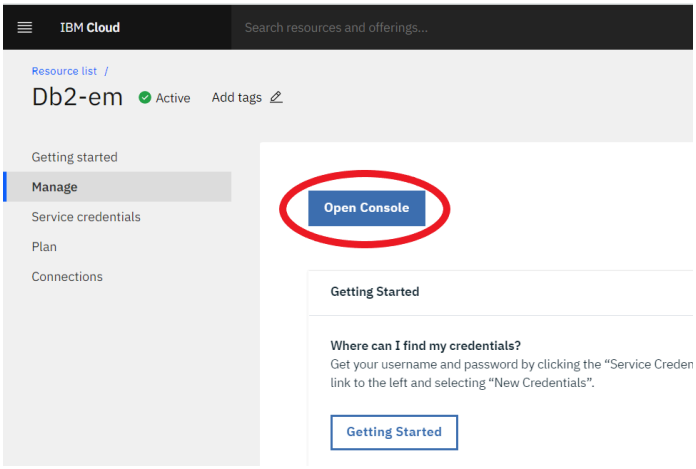


Figure 1.11 Access the DB2 Interface.

You are now on the main interface of DB2 on where you can create and manipulate objects of your database. The hamburger icon in Figure 1.12 provides the different functions to modify the content of your database.

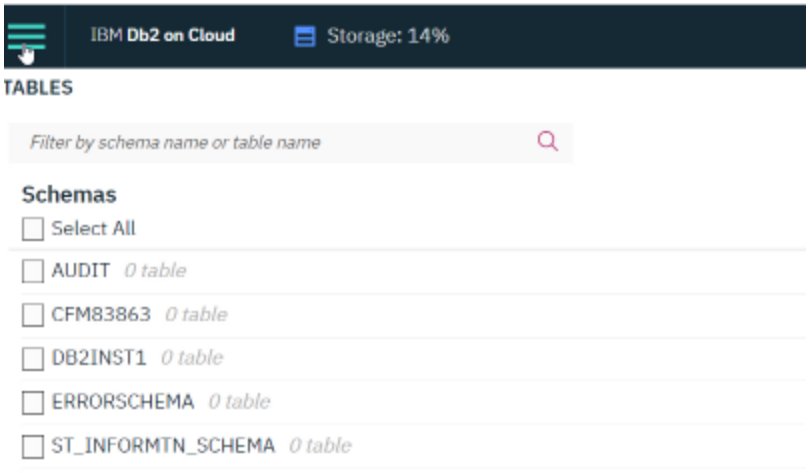


Figure 1.12 Main interface of DB2.

For now, we need to log out from DB2 and IBM Cloud.

To log out, click the **sign out** button.

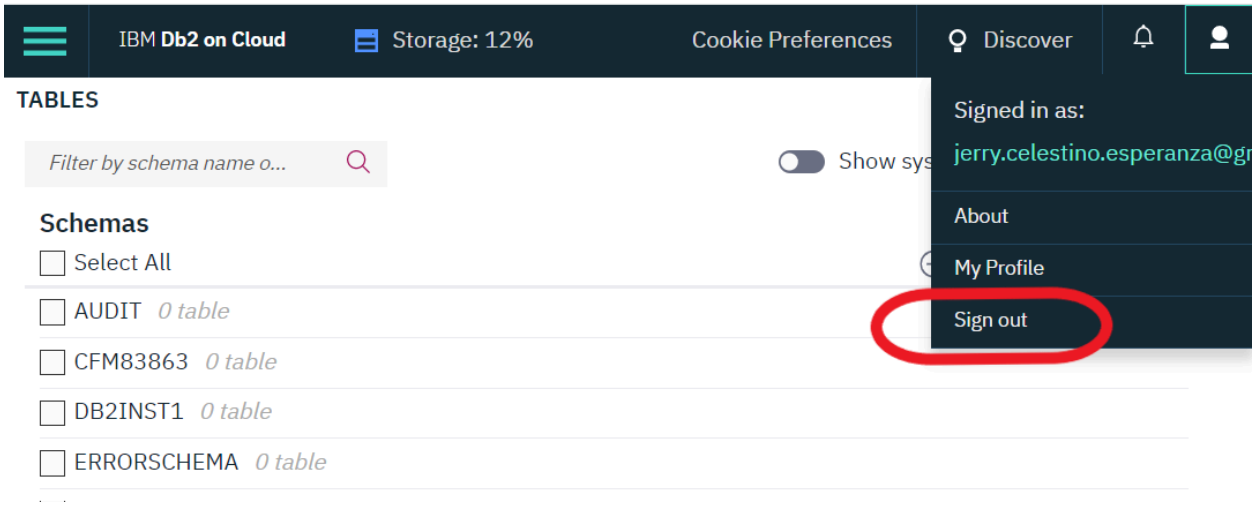


Figure 1.13 Sign out at DB2 Cloud.

To complete log-out from IBM Cloud, access the **Service Details** tab and sign out just the same.

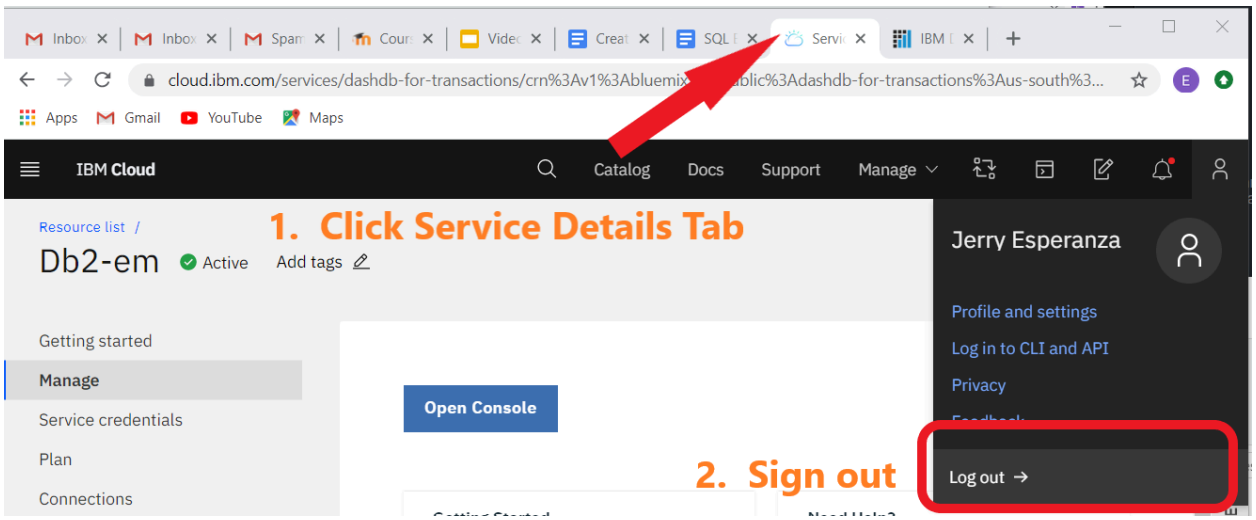


Figure 1.14 Complete Sign-out from IBM Cloud.

Return to IBM DB2 Interface

You may access again your IBM DB2 account by simply accessing the link https://cloud.ibm.com

Provide your access credentials to the login form and you will go back to the main dashboard of IBM Cloud.

In the main dashboard, you will see that there is already 1 service active in the row of **Services**. That service is the DB2 service application.

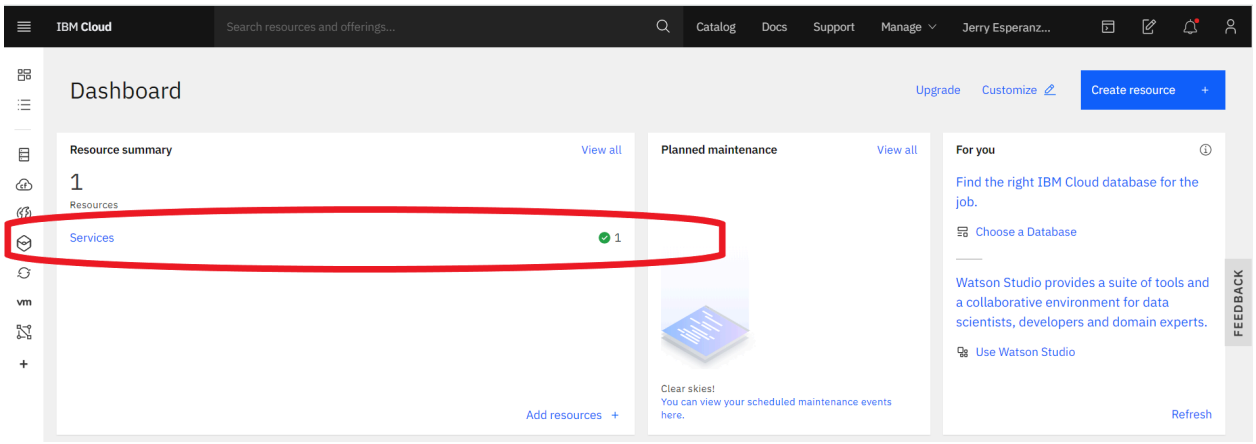


Figure 1.15 Main dashboard with Services.

Click the **Services** link to display the Resource List page.

The next page displays the resource list offered in the IBM Cloud. Here, you will notice the DB2 instance name that you have created before. Click Services | DB2 instance to proceed on the next step to access the DB2 interface.

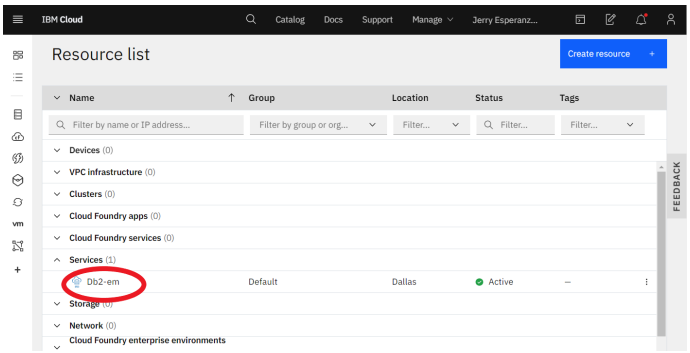


Figure 1.16 DB2 instance name.

Click **Open console**.

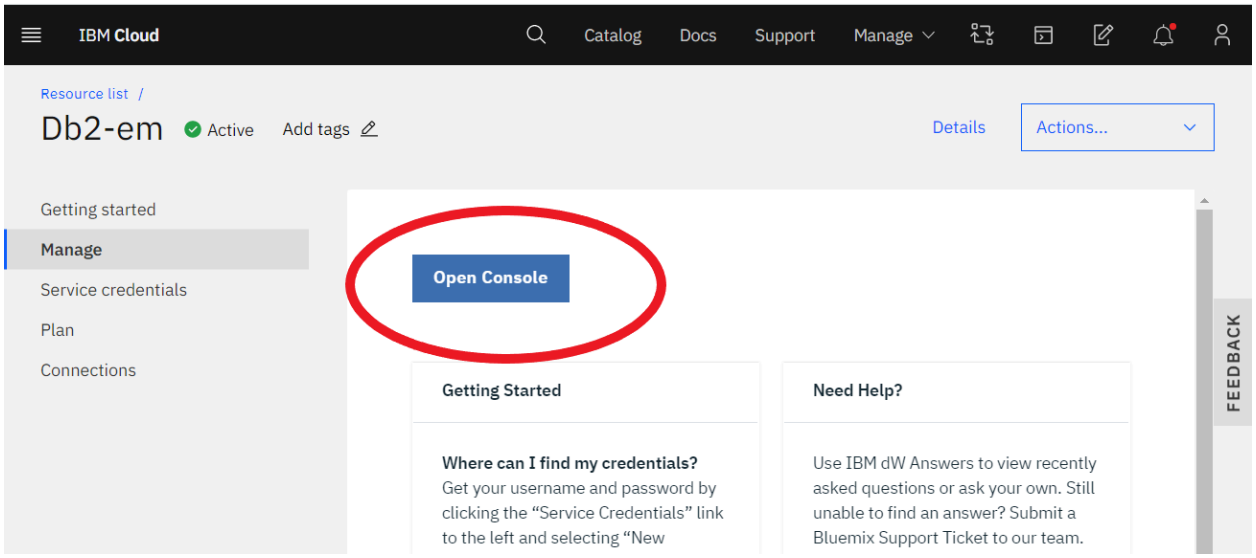


Figure 1.17 Open console page.

And you are back to the main interface of DB2 Cloud.

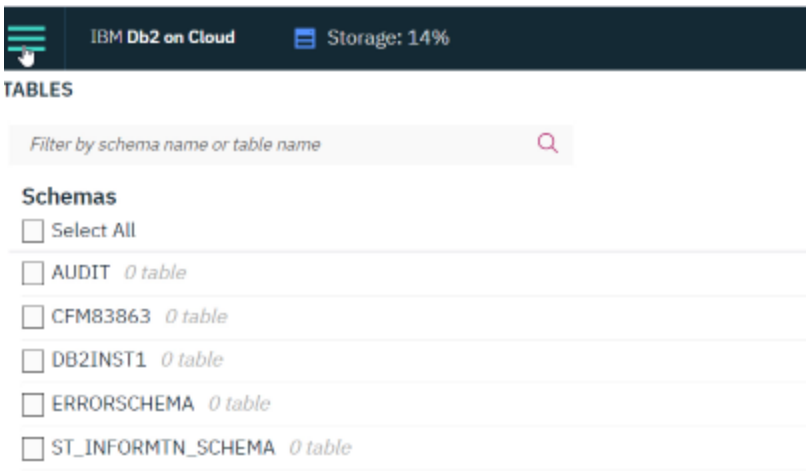


Figure 1.18 Main interface of DB2 Cloud.

Renew your monthly DB2 Lite Account Access

IBM requires every user of the Lite Account to renew their monthly subscription to continue accessing the service for free. This gives an opportunity to others to use the space left by inactive users.

You will receive an email below. Just click the link provided in the email to renew your account.

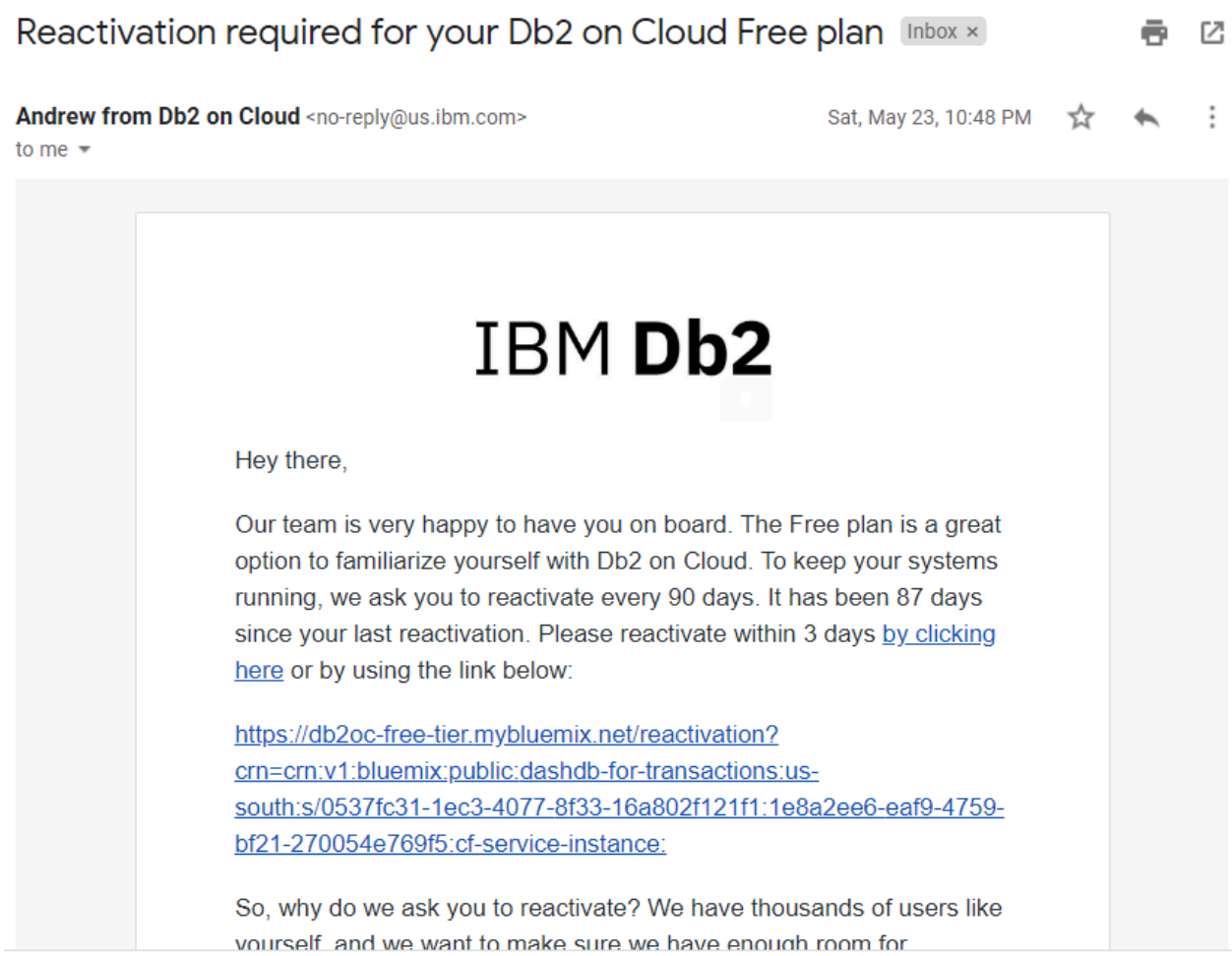


Figure 1.19 Renewal of the Lite Account